INR 10,500 in the state while providing opportunities to international travellers to spend anywhere between INR 45,000 to INR 73,000 in the state.

This will be achieved by motivating the guests to extend their stay duration at the destination and encourage repeat visitation for both national and international travellers. The state plans to promote innovation for this and enhance productivity and competitiveness of the sector via use of digital technologies and introduction of new tourism products and services.

The policy encourages incentives for capital investment, encourages women entrepreneurs, boosts participation in tourism-related exhibitions in the country and abroad as well as provides CGST rebate, concessions in power tariff and financial assistance for MSMEs.

Rolling out the red carpet for mega investments in this sector, the state plans to extend fiscal aids in the form of Capital Investment Incentive, Interest Subvention, Viability Gap Funding, Seed Fund, Green Incentives, Certification/ Quality Upgradation/R&D, Turnover linked incentives, Special Thrust Sector Incentive, Employment Generation, Development Capital Support and further more special economic incentives to engage to promote the backward communities of the state. Non Fiscal encouragement includes extending Industry Status, Entrepreneurship awards and a speedy integration into the National Single Window System.

The sectors that would be benefited include Hotels, Motels, Hostels, Resorts, Cottages, Rural Eco-tourism units, Homestays, Rental Homes, Tented Accommodation, Tree House, Mud cottages and their like. Cruise boats, Yachts, Wayside Amenities, Restaurants, Food Courts at Tourist destinations, Beach Shacks are another set that should see business.

MICE or Convention Centres, Exhibition Spaces, Wellness Centres, Ropeways, Amusement Parks, Golf Courses, Caravans & Caravan Park, Heli Tourism projects, Unity Malls, AR-VR Zones, 7 D and above Experience, Global Tourism Village, Art and Cultural Center etc. should also see traction. Art Galleries, Handloom/Handicraft shops should garner business. Developers of adventure tourism landing sites, Hospitality Parks and E-Vehicles for tourist should gain business.


WATER SCOOTER

These get well reflected in some of the specific schemes floated by the Maharashtra Directorate of Tourism:

'Aai' Gender Inclusive Tourism Policy: DOT supports women entrepreneurs by registering women-owned businesses in sectors such as homestays, hotels, and travel agencies across each district.

The 'Aai' policy is a significant step towards empowering female travelers and promoting gender inclusivity in tourism. This policy offers a range of exclusive benefits and facilities for women, including a 50% discount on bookings at MTDC resorts during specific periods, particularly around International Women's Day. Additionally, the policy supports women-run facilities, women self-help groups, and makes special arrangements for women with disabilities and those traveling with young children.

Agro-Tourism policy is a forward-thinking initiative aimed at boosting rural development by promoting agriculture-based tourism. This policy is designed to offer tourists an authentic experience of rural life, including farm activities, organic local flavors, and traditional arts and crafts. The key objectives and benefits of the agro-tourism policy include:

Enhancing Rural Development: The policy seeks to develop villages by promoting agribusiness and creating market opportunities for agricultural produce.

Creating Employment Opportunities: It focuses on generating jobs, especially for women and youth in rural areas.

Encouraging Agro-Based Businesses: Farmers and agricultural institutions can set up agro-tourism centers, with support for easy bank loans and reduced regulatory requirements.

Promoting Environmental Sustainability: The policy encourages eco-friendly tourism and aims to provide a pollution-free environment for visitors.

The policy simplifies the process for farmers to establish agro-tourism centers by reducing the need for non-agricultural certificates for projects of up to eight rooms within five acres of land.

DOT has also launched a comprehensive Caravan Tourism Policy aimed at introducing caravan travel and parks to boost tourism. Key details of the policy include:

Caravan Features: Caravans are specially-built vehicles designed for travel, leisure, and accommodation, equipped with essential amenities such as beds, kitchens, toilets, and living areas.

Caravan Parks: Designated areas where caravans can park overnight, offering amenities like water refilling, battery charging, sewage disposal, food courts, and information on local attractions. These parks can be set up on private or government land, including MTDC guest house areas and open lands where permanent construction is restricted.

Government Incentives: Benefits such as waivers on stamp duty, electricity duties, and GST refunds for tour operators. The policy includes a registration fee for caravans and caravan parks.

Implementation and Management: DOT collaborates with private players to operate the caravans while providing facilities at DOT resorts. Caravans will be available for hire, including a driver and assistant, with capacities ranging from five to six guests.

Yuva Mandal policy focuses on promoting local youth participation in the tourism sector through training, financial support, and opportunities to manage and operate tourism-related services and facilities. The policy includes:

Training Programs: DOT organizes training sessions to equip young people with the necessary skills for managing and operating tourism services.

Financial Assistance: Provides financial aid and subsidies to young entrepreneurs to start their own tourism-related businesses.

Employment Opportunities: Encourages the hiring of local youth in various DOT projects and initiatives.

Collaboration with Educational Institutions: Works with local colleges and universities to create tourism-related courses and workshops.

Youth-Led Projects: Supports projects led by youth groups, especially those that promote sustainable and eco-friendly tourism practices.

These proactive measures by DOT are designed to diversify the tourism offerings in Maharashtra, making it a more attractive destination for both domestic and international tourists. The initiatives also promote inclusivity, sustainability, and local economic development, ensuring that the benefits of tourism are widely distributed across different segments of society.



FERRY CRUISE TOURISM